

Allen Smith Selected For Bat Boy Job

Crew-cut Allen Smith yesterday won a big stake in his future when he was selected winner of The Indianapolis Star Bat Boy Contest.

And Allen starts to work right away. Tonight he'll tote the lumber for the Denver Bears, opponents of the Indianapolis Indians at Victory Field in the season opener.

Allen was handpicked yesterday over nine other finalists in a two-hour judging session at the Tribe park.

JUDGING the candidates, top letter writers of more than 500 who wrote The Star telling why they wanted the job, were Tribe Manager Walker Cooper, Coach Johnny Hutchings, Club General Manager Ray Johnston and Star Sports Editor Jep Cadou Jr.

They judged the boys the way bat boys should be selected—on the diamond.

The judges watched the 10 aspirants in drills—throwing to Cooper who stationed himself in center field, running to first base, and hitting off Hutchings. Smith, a 14-year-old Ben Davis High School freshman, connected on a drive off the former Tribe and major league hurler that carried to the wall. Jovial John commented to Allen "Next time I throw you curves."

After the diamond warm-up each candidate was personally interviewed for the job in the Tribe office. Each boy read his letter and answered questions to indicate his qualifications for the job.

THIS SEASON Allen will work with visiting teams. He'll get off to a good start tonight when Denver Manager Andy Cohen calls the plays. Andy, as Indian boss last season, judged bat boy candidates.

Next year he'll move across the diamond to work with the Tribe. To culminate his two seasons as bat boy, Smith will be taken with the Tribe on a road trip.

He will be paid by the game and also will receive a \$400 college scholarship which he may use at the school of his choice, which happens to be Indiana Central College for Allen. Allen wants to major in physical education and would like to coach if he can't make the grade in professional baseball.

Allen has played baseball—his favorite sport—since he was a small child. The 5-3, 135-pounder plays shortstop and catcher. He was captain of his Little League team.

LAST YEAR Allen saw three-fourths of the Indians' games and rated Ron Jackson, the big first sacker now with the Chicago White Sox, his favorite player.

Allen, the son of Mr. and Mrs. Arnold Smith, 3225 West 29th Street, has one sister and one brother. His father is a salesman for Lumberman's Wholesale Supply Corp.

"I don't know how to thank the judges and The Star for this honor," Allen said when notified he was the winner. It is the first contest the boy ever has won.

Allen will be honored May 23 when Bat Boy night is observed at Victory Field. Prior to the game against Charleston, Allen will be honored in ceremonies at home plate when he will be awarded a wrist watch. To share in his "night," all the students and faculty of Ben Davis will be admitted to the game as Allen's guests.

In case Allen is unable to work every game, judges selected 13-year-old David A. Steckler, 325 East 45th Street, as alternate bat boy. David, an eighth grade student at Public School No. 70, is the son of Federal judge and Mrs. William E. Steckler.